

TẬP I

Session 19

Instructor: Hồ Lê Vũ



Start recording...

OVERVIEW

- HUMOR

Slide No 4

- Article: [Difference Between American and British Humor](#)
→ *watch a typical sample of British Humor*

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN AMERICAN AND BRITISH HUMOUR *by* **Ricky Gervais**

(Apart from the spelling of the word, obviously)

It's often dangerous to generalize, but under threat, I would say that Americans are more “**down the line.**” They don't hide their hopes and fears. They applaud ambition and openly reward success. Brits are more comfortable with life's losers. We embrace the underdog until it's no longer the underdog. We like to bring authority **down a peg or two. Just for the hell of it.** Americans say, “have a nice day” whether they mean it or not. Brits are terrified to say this. We tell ourselves it's because we don't want to sound insincere but I think it might be for the opposite reason. We don't want to **celebrate anything too soon.** Failure and disappointment **lurk around every corner.** This is due to our upbringing. Americans are **brought up** to believe they can be the next president of the United States. Brits are told, “*it won't happen for you.*” In Britain we stop watching things like Big Brother when the villain is evicted. We don't want to watch a bunch of idiots having a good time. We want them to be as miserable as us. America rewards up front, **on-your-sleeve** niceness. A perceived wicked **streak** is somewhat **frowned upon.**

STRUCTURES

- Americans are more “**down the line.**” They don’t hide their hopes and fears.
 - **in the future** [N] vs. **down the line** | **down the road** [I] vs. **hereafter** [F]
 - I'm sure at some point **in the future** I'll want a baby.
 - The judge said compensation would be considered further **down the road.**
 - We don't know what will happen **hereafter.**

STRUCTURES

- We like to bring authority down a peg or two. Just for the hell of it.
 - Something deep in our psyche takes delight in hearing of the rich and powerful being taken down a peg.
 - I decided to dye my hair bright green, just for the heck of it [I].
 - heck [I, less offensive] < hell [I] → watch sample clips
 - It's an outdoorsy place for me to speak to God.
Don't you already speak to him indoorsy? [I, diminutive]

STRUCTURES

- We don't want to celebrate anything too soon. Failure and disappointment lurk around every corner.
 - After the riot, police were stationed on | at every corner.

STRUCTURES

- Americans are **brought up** to believe they can be the next president of the United States.
- vs. I hate to **bring this up** but you still owe me \$50.
- **mention** [N] vs. **bring up** [I→N] vs. **note** [F]
 - The report **mentions** that the cost is higher than expected.
 - The growth of trade was **noted** in the last chapter.
- *watch sample clips*

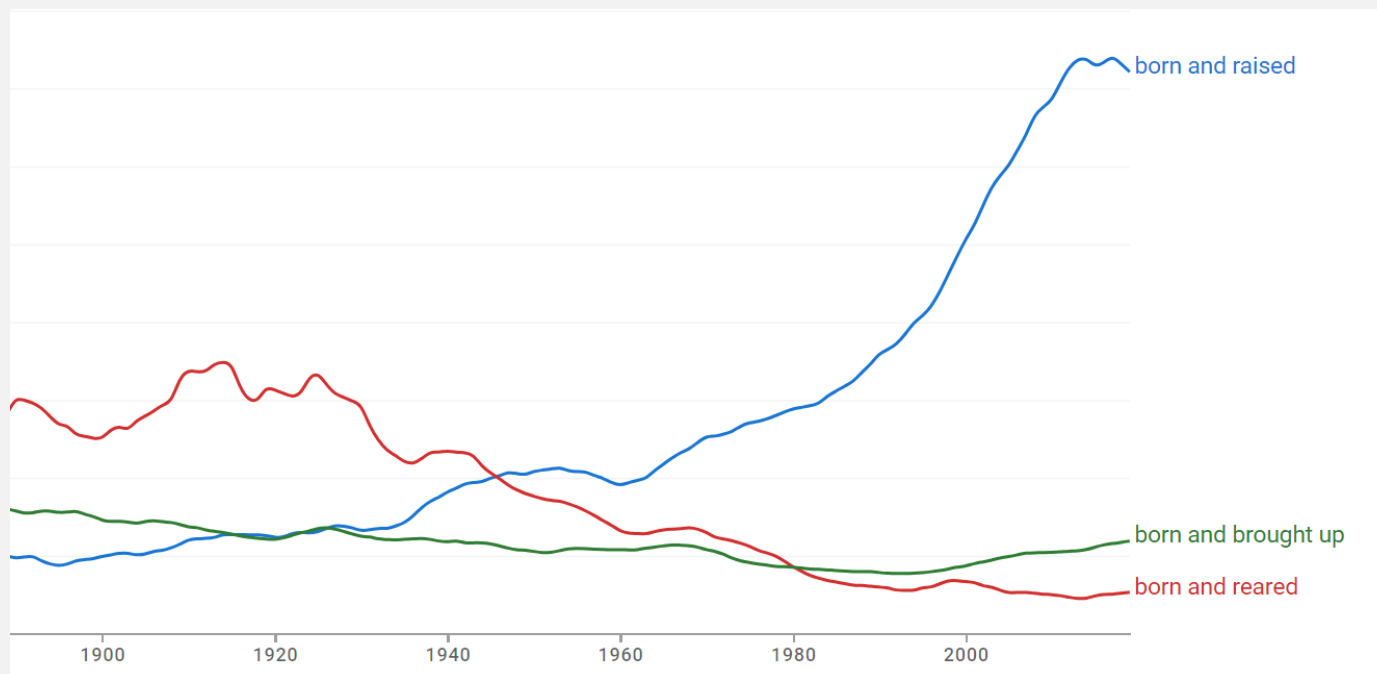
STRUCTURES

→ *watch sample clips*

- get the **ringside seat**
- I **ain't** blind to your flaws.
 - be **not** | have **not** [N] vs. **ain't** [I, S]
 - Well, it's obvious, **ain't** it?
They **ain't** got no kids.
- You **have an opinion about everything**

STRUCTURES

- I didn't **raise** you to be thinking you're not good enough.
 - **raise** [N] vs. **bring up** [I→N] vs. **rear** [N→O]
 - She **reared** six children.
 - I was **reared** in east Texas.
 - sinh ra và lớn lên?
 - I was **born** and **raised** in Hanoi.

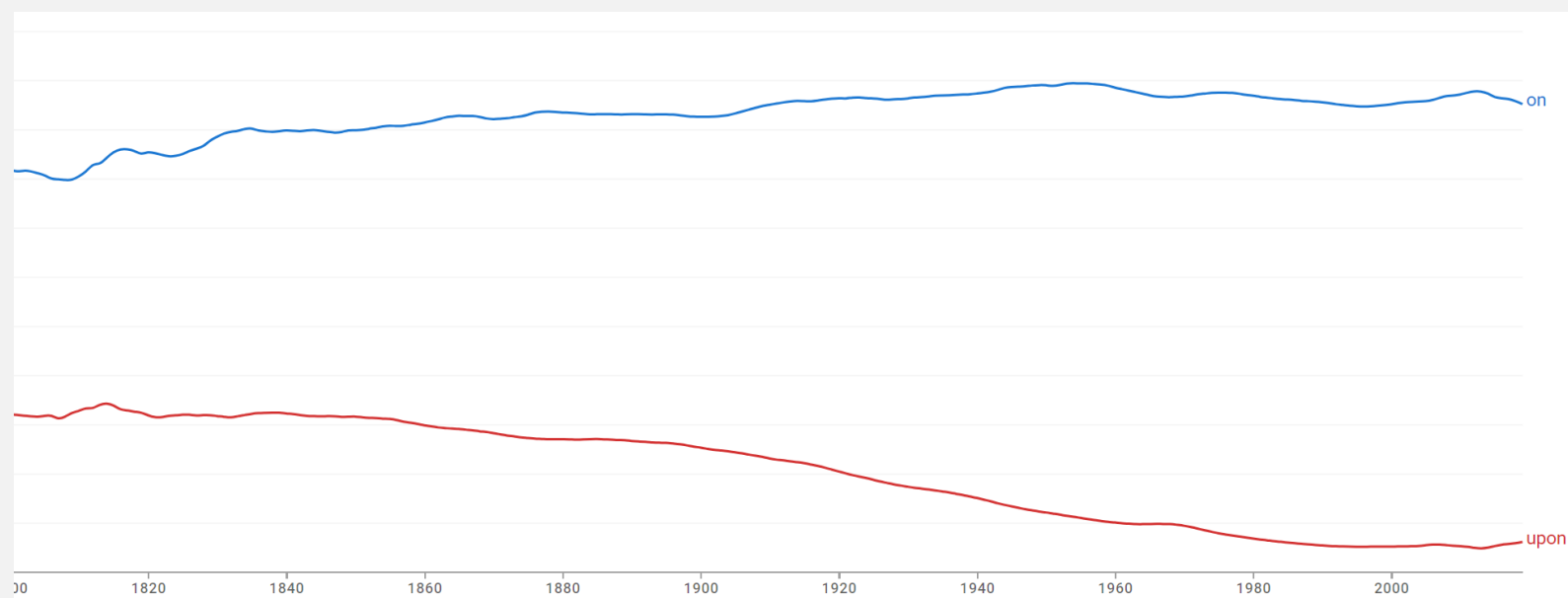


STRUCTURES

- I just hate feeling like I always have to **put on a face for** you.
- I know you're angry. You might as well say what you have to now and **get it out of your system**.
- I guess I **get it from** you.
 - **inherit** [N] vs. **get from** [I] vs. **genetically receive** [F]
 - The boys **inherited** Derek's good looks.
 - She **got her beauty from** her mom.
 - My dad was Irish and my mother was German. I had **genetically received** the German sense of humor and the Irish sense of order.
Communicative skills are not **genetically received**, but learned and thus can be improved.

STRUCTURES

- A perceived wicked streak is somewhat **frowned upon**.
 - **Heaven will frown upon** | **on** [O] such acts of terrorism.
 - vs. **Heaven didn't smile on** [O] the new president.
 - **on** [N] vs. **upon** [F, L, O]
 - We all were put **on** vs. **upon** this earth for a purpose.
 - My whole future depends **on** vs. **upon** this one test.



TEXT

There's a **received wisdom** in the U.K. that Americans don't get irony. This is of course not true. But what is true is that they don't use it all the time. It shows up in the smarter comedies but Americans don't use it as much socially as Brits. We use it as liberally as prepositions in every day speech. We tease our friends. We use sarcasm as a shield and a weapon. We avoid sincerity until it's absolutely necessary. We mercilessly **take the piss out of** people we like or dislike basically. This can sometimes be perceived as nasty if the recipients aren't used to it. It isn't. It's **play fighting**. It's almost a sign of affection if we like you, and ego bursting if we don't. You just have to know which one it is. We also take the piss out of ourselves. This is very important. Our brashness and swagger is **laden with** equal portions of **self-deprecation**. This is our **license** to hand it out.

STRUCTURES

- There's a **received wisdom** in the U.K. that Americans don't get irony.
 - **conventional wisdom** [N] vs. **received wisdom** [F]
 - The study challenges the **conventional wisdom** that exercise is good for you.
 - [IELTS tips] Traditionally, the **received opinion** was that, in the event of a divorce, the mother should **get custody of the children**.



STRUCTURES

- We mercilessly **take the piss out of** [I, BR] people we like or dislike and ourselves.
 - I was **made fun of** because I was fat.
 - *watch a sample clip* and see how they make fun of the **Prime Minister**. Do they like or dislike him?

STRUCTURES

- It's **play fighting**. It's almost a sign of affection if we like you.



STRUCTURES

- Our brashness and swagger is laden with equal portions of self-deprecation.
 - laden with guilt | laden with debt
 - She's one of those girls who uses self-deprecation as a defense mechanism.
 - She told the story of her life with self-deprecating humor.

FOOD FOR THOUGHT

- to self-deprecate [OP] vs. to feign modesty [ON]
 - I can't say it out loud. Modesty forbids.

modest vs. humble

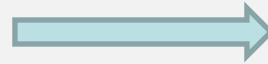
Quizzes

- He remains _____ about his success.
- She seems a _____ lady as she never boasts or talks much about her own abilities.
- Life achievements of these Nobel prize winners made us feel _____.

FOOD FOR THOUGHT

MODEST

self



HUMBLE

other

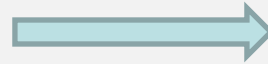
- She seems a **modest** lady as she never boasts or talks much about her own abilities.
- Life achievements of these Nobel prize winners made us feel **humble**.
- He's very **modest** vs. **humble** about his success.
- **arrogant** vs. **conceited**

Interchangeable usage in real life
(involving **synecdoche**)



FOOD FOR THOUGHT

MODEST
CONCEITED
self



HUMBLE
ARROGANT
other

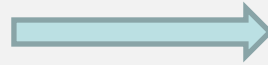
- The **arrogant** lawyer elbowed his way to the head of the line of customers, declaring that he was too busy to wait like everybody else.
- It's very **conceited** of you to assume that your work is always the best.

Interchangeable usage in real life
(involving **synecdoche**)

- One can be confident without seeming **conceited** vs. **arrogant**.
- Một lần khiêm tốn bằng bốn lần tự kiêu?

SOLUTIONS

MODEST
CONCEITED
self



HUMBLE
ARROGANT
other

- Một lần khiêm tốn bằng bốn lần tự kiêu
 - Humility is the worst form of conceit

STRUCTURES

- This is our **license** to hand it out.
- [ON] **freedom** [N] vs. **a free pass** [I→N] vs. **license** [F] to do something
- Being an adult doesn't give you complete **freedom** to do as you wish.
 - Just because you're famous, you don't get **a free pass** to break the law.
 - Being angry doesn't give you **license** to treat others so rudely.

TEXT

Recently I have been accused of being a shock comic, and cruel and cynical. But **nothing could be further from the truth**. I never actively try to offend. That's churlish, pointless and frankly too easy. But I believe you should say what you mean. Be honest. No one should ever be offended by truth. That way you'll never have to apologize. I hate it when a comedian says, "*Sorry for what I said.*" You shouldn't say it if you didn't mean it and you should never regret anything you meant to do. As a comedian, I think my job isn't just to make people laugh but also make them think. As a famous comedian, I also want a strict **door policy** on my club. Not everyone will like what I say or find it funny. And I **wouldn't have it any other way**.

STRUCTURES

- I never actively try to offend. That's **churlish**, pointless and frankly too easy.

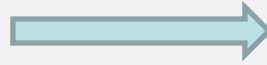
rude [N] vs. **cheeky** [I] vs. **churlish** [F]

- He's got no manners - he's **rude** to everyone.
- It would be **churlish** to refuse such a generous offer.
- You asked your teacher how old she was? That was a bit **cheeky**!

rude vs. **impolite**

STRUCTURES

IMPOLITE
accident



RUDE
intention

- It would be **impolite** to leave in the middle of the band's set.
- There's no need to be **rude**!
- I apologize if I seemed **rude**, but that wasn't my **intention**.

Interchangeable usage in real life
(involving **synecdoche**)

- It's **impolite** vs. **rude** not to say "Thank you" when you are given something.

STRUCTURES

- As a famous comedian, I also want a strict **door policy** on my club.
 - Our club has a strict **door policy**. No **slippers/sandals, shorts and singlets**. If you don't follow **the dress code**, you won't get in, no matter how much you spend.



STRUCTURES

- Not everyone will like what I say or find it funny. And I **wouldn't have it** any other way.

allow [N] vs. **let** [I→N] vs. **not have** [I, negative form]
vs. **permit** [N→F] vs. **grant** [F]

- Smoking is not **allowed** in this restaurant.
- He'd eat chocolate all day long if I **let** him.
Alice's mum won't **let** her come with us.
- Visitors are not **permitted** to take photographs.
- They were **granted** a meeting | She was **granted** a divorce.
- She wanted to be alone. They wouldn't **have it**.
I'm **not having** any of that nonsense. → *watch sample clips*

[formality] let < allow < permit

- e.g., offering help
 - Let me help you with that.
 - "Allow me," he said, taking the tray from her.
 - Permit me to offer you some advice.
- e.g., discussing permission
 - About this "extreme" haircut, the school does not permit, my parents do not allow but my brother let me.

permit vs. license

FOOD FOR THOUGHT

[verb] to **license** = to officially **permit**

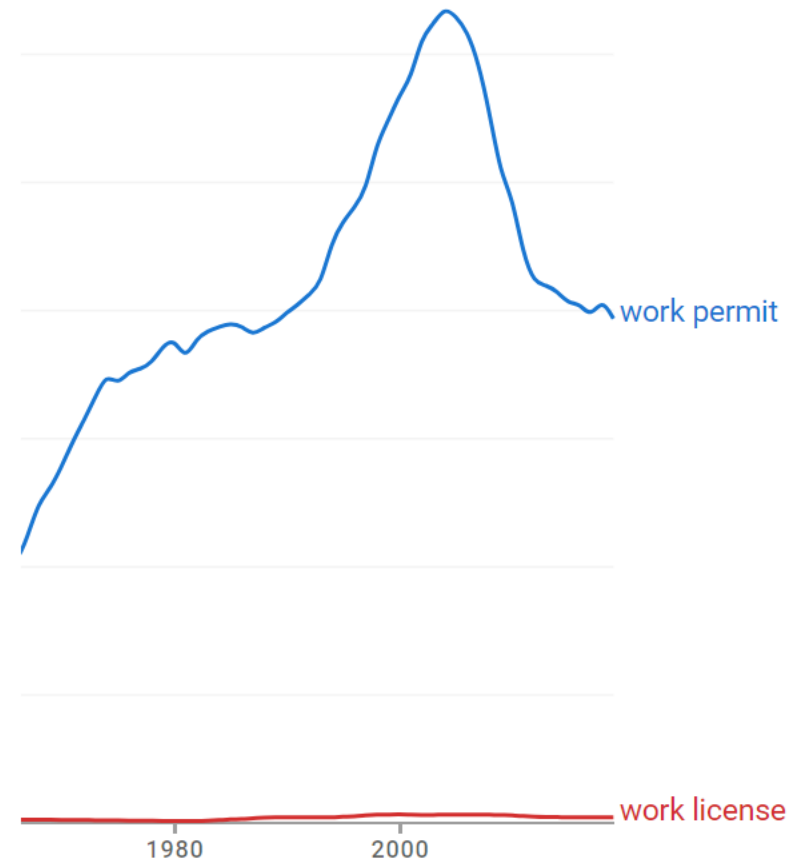
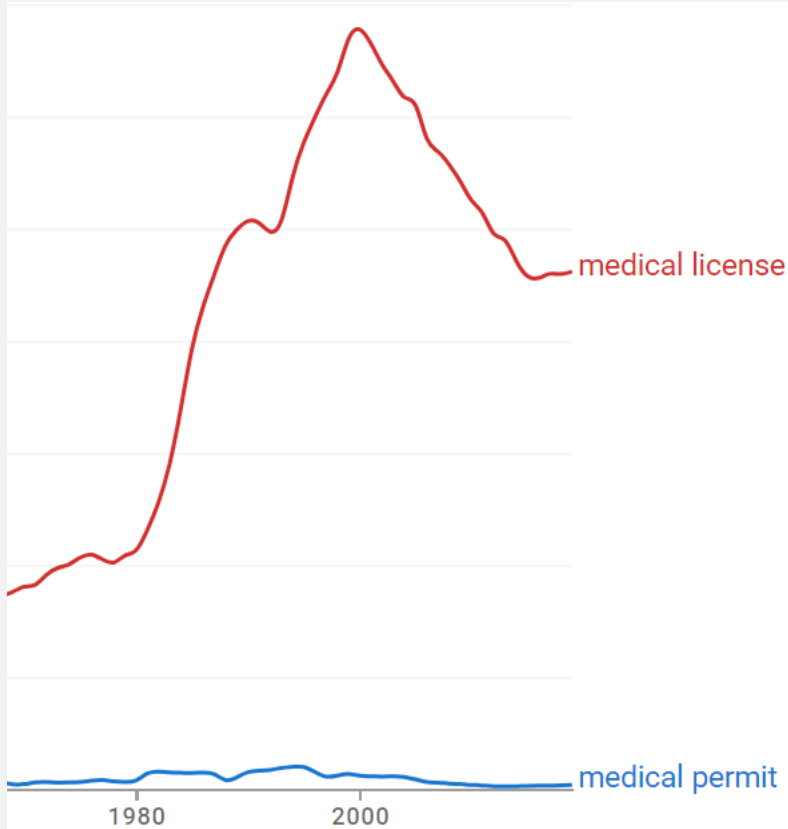
- The new drug has not yet been **licensed** in the US.
 - Several companies have been **licensed** to sell these products.

[noun] **license** vs. **permit**

- While **permits** and **licenses** are both issued by the authority, the former require regular inspections, limited time, and more restrictions, while the latter are more or less permanent, with fewer restrictions and fewer inspections.
- A learner's **permit** is given to a person who is learning to drive, but has not yet satisfied the prerequisite to obtain a driver's **license**.

FOOD FOR THOUGHT

[noun] **license** vs. **permit**



TEXT

I'm not one of those people who think that comedy is your **conscience taking a day off**. My conscience never takes a day off and I can justify everything I do. There's **no line to be drawn** in comedy in the sense that there's nothing that you should never joke about. It depends what that joke is. The subject of a joke isn't necessarily the target of the joke. You can make jokes about race without any race being **the butt of the joke**. Racism itself can be the butt, for example. I don't like racist jokes. Not because they are offensive. I don't like them because they're not funny. And they're not funny because they're not true. Comedy is an intellectual pursuit. Not a platform.

As for cynicism, I don't care for it much. **For the record**, I'm a romantic. For me, goodness and sweetness, honour and truth, love and friendship always **triumph**. For me, humanity is king.

STRUCTURES

- Comedy is your conscience taking a day off.
táng tận lương tâm?
 - What morally bankrupt monster am I taking down?
lương tâm trong sạch?
 - sleep | vote with a clear conscience

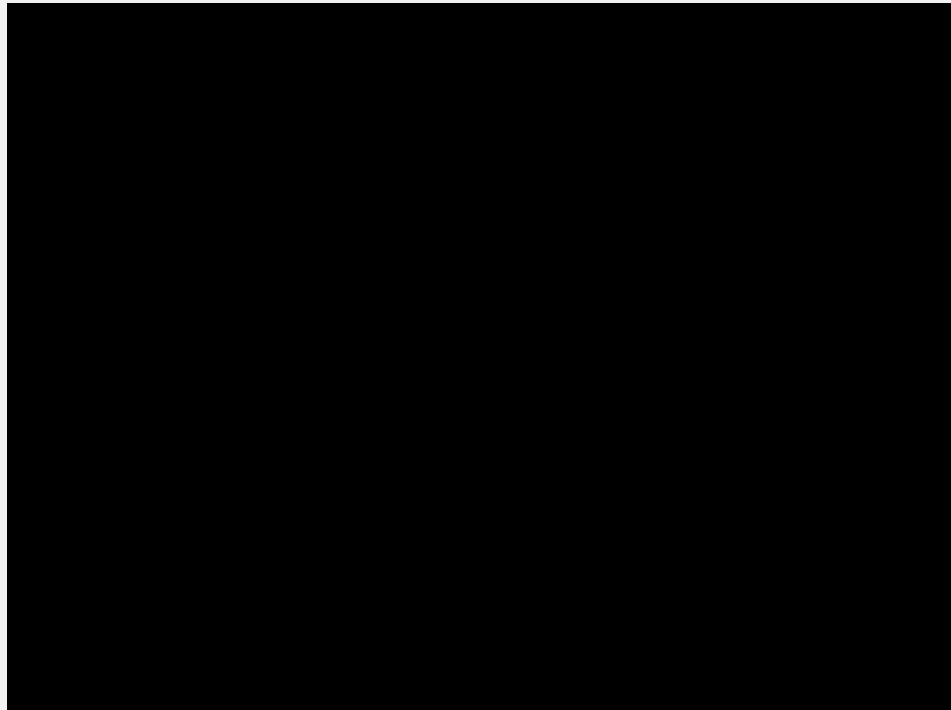
STRUCTURES

- There's **no line to be drawn** in comedy.
 - Cosmo is all about having fun, but we **draw the line at** anything that could put your health at risk.
 - *watch sample clips*
- (it's a) **Long story...** [I]
- This is **the last straw** [**that broke the camel's back**].
- You always do everything you can to **come between** me and any woman I'm serious about.

Dear Santa,

**..it's a long
story •**

- You can make jokes about race without any race being **the butt of the joke**.
 - = He's still **the brunt of** cruel **jokes** about his small town origins.
 - vs. Well, **the joke is on** [I] you.
 - He thought he could steal my job by telling the boss terrible things about me, but **the joke's on** him — he's actually the one who got fired.



STRUCTURES

- For the record I'm a romantic. → *watch sample clips*
 - [duly] noted [N→F] vs. got it [I]

STRUCTURES

- For me, love and friendship always triumph.
- win [N] vs. come out on top [I] vs. prevail [F] vs. triumph [N→L]
- They won the war, although it cost them millions of lives.
France won by six goals to two against Denmark.
- In most boardroom disputes he tends to come out on top.
Despite the odds, our team came out on top against Castle United.
- In the end, the Chinese view prevailed.
The Italian team eventually prevailed over Russia 5-3.
- Good triumphs over evil in the end.
France triumphed 3–0 in the final.
vs. They stood atop the mountain in triumph.

STRUCTURES

win [N] vs. come out on top [I] vs. prevail [F] vs. triumph [N→L]

lose [N] vs. drop [I→N] vs. undergo defeat [N→F]

- They **lost** the Italian Cup Final.
- The tennis star has yet to **drop** a set.
The team **dropped** three games in a row.
- Humphrey was nominated and **underwent defeat** by Richard Nixon.
In the second game, Check couldn't work a miracle and **underwent defeat**.
- Andy is a **grumpy** | **sore** | **bad loser**. He totally hates losing.
vs. Mrs. Oliver, though a bad bridge player, was a **sporting** | **good loser**. She paid up cheerfully.

STRUCTURES

win [N] vs. come out on top [I] vs. prevail [F] vs. triumph [N→L]

lose [N] vs. drop [I→N] vs. undergo defeat [N→F]

draw | tie vs. be even steven | stephen [I, rhyming]

vs. have an equal score [N→F]

- The game ended in a draw. | Holland and Ireland drew 1-1.
- Their record was 3 wins, 6 losses and a tie.
We tied with Spain in third place.
- At the end of the game the two teams were even Stephen.
The result was an even-steven first half with both sides missing chances to grab themselves a lead.
- In accordance with USPGA recommendations, if players have an equal score the following count-back system will be applied.

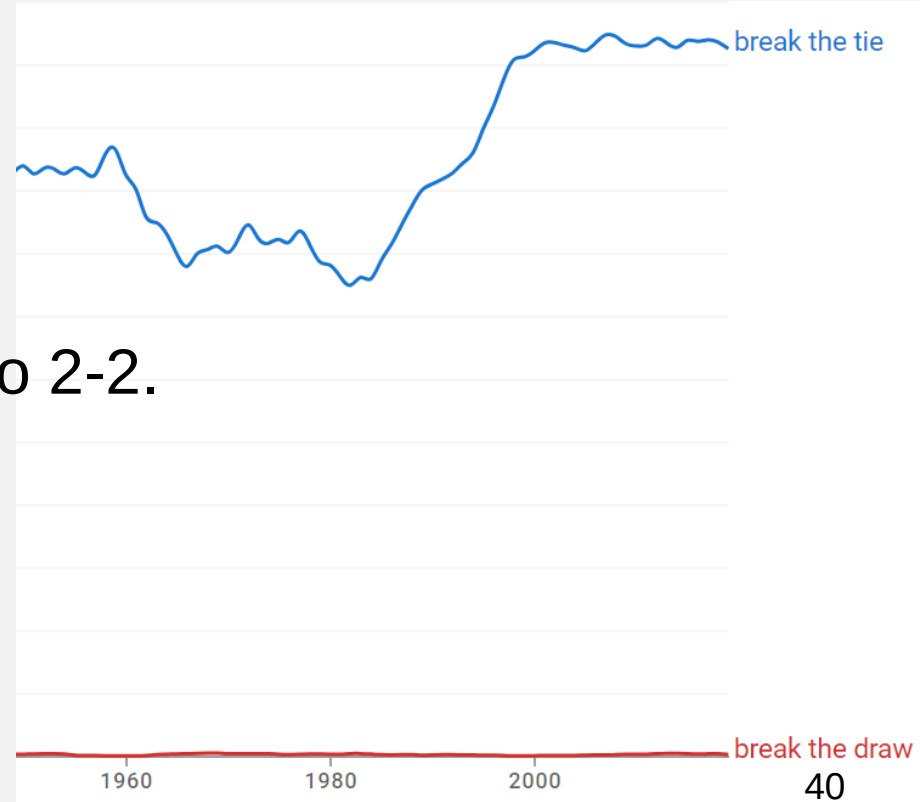
FOOD FOR THOUGHT

draw [mainly BR] vs. tie

- draw can only be used to refer to *the score at the end* of a game, whereas tie can be used at *any other time* as well.
- Americans seldom use draw for sports. They do use it in several other cases, e.g., chess, boxing and card games.

gỡ hòa?

- With seconds left on the clock
Japan level [N]
vs. evened out [I→N]
vs. equalized [I→F] the score to 2-2.



FUN ACTIVITY

- *More British humor...*

GROUP ACTIVITY

- Để dịch các cụm từ sau đây, chúng ta cần dùng những cấu trúc nào đã học ngày hôm nay trong lớp? (chỉ được phép có một đáp án cho mỗi cụm từ)
 - cây **trĩu** quả
 - mình **ứ chịu** đâu
 - yêu thì **củ ấu cũng tròn**
 - mình **thích thì mình làm thôi**

HOMEWORK

- Session 20
 - TIME TRAVEL